

The Five Moves

What it takes for training to actually reach a classroom. None of these cost money.

FOR Whoever schedules or designs professional learning in your building. Principal, assistant principal, PD coordinator, instructional coach. If that is not you, this is the page to hand them. The next three pages are yours.

5 to 10%

of a new skill reaches practice after training alone

Above 90%

reaches practice when sustained coaching is added

Joyce, B. and Showers, B. *Student Achievement Through Staff Development*. Replicated since the early 1980s. The gap is not about content or budget. It is about what happens in the two weeks after.

The adults standing closest to your highest-need students get the least training, the least coaching and the least follow up. That is a structural problem, not a people problem, and these five moves are how a building fixes it.

01 Schedule the return before you deliver the first session

The follow up date goes on the calendar at the same moment the training date does, and carries the same weight.

The test. If it can be cancelled because something came up, it is not a follow up. It is an intention. Everything gets cancelled by something coming up.

02 One action, one context, one time, in writing

Before anyone leaves, they name one specific thing they will do. Not "I will build more relationships." Something like "Monday at the 10:40 transition I will meet Marcus at the door and give him a job to carry."

The test. Specific enough that you could ask about it by name three weeks later. If you cannot, it was a mood, not a commitment.

03 Ask what happened, not whether they liked it

The return conversation is "you said you would meet Marcus at the door. Did you? What happened?" Offer five answers, not two.

- I tried it
- I adapted it
- I am still trying
- I got stuck
- It did not land

The test. Three of your five answers are failure states, and saying one out loud costs the person nothing.

04 What the adult writes never reaches their evaluator

If someone writes "I froze, I did not know what to say," and a supervisor might read it in an evaluation context, you will never get a true answer from that person again. Worse, you will not know it stopped.

The test. Leadership sees counts. Leadership never sees the text. Settle this before the first session, because the first breach is permanent.

05 Somebody watches the work

It does not have to be an instructional coach. It can be a peer, or the person down the hall who is good at the thing you are bad at, for fifteen minutes.

The test. It cannot be nobody, and "their teacher will support them" is nobody, because the teacher is teaching. It is on a calendar with a name next to it, or it is not real.

Ask For It

Four of the five moves need authority over a calendar. If you are the one in the classroom or the hallway rather than the one booking the room, this page is yours.

Most people who sit through professional development have no control over how it is designed. That does not leave you without a move. It leaves you with one, and it is the fastest way this changes.

Go to whoever schedules your training and say this

"I want to be asked what I am going to try before I leave the session. And I want somebody to come back in three weeks and ask me how it went. Even if it did not work."

That is it. Two sentences. It costs the building nothing and it is the difference between training that disappears and training that lands.

Nobody is going to hand you this. A system that has never been asked has never had to answer, and asking out loud is the single fastest way it starts to.

Then ask two questions of somebody else

Pick one adult who works closer to a struggling child than you do. A paraprofessional, a support staff member, a new hire, a bus driver, a lunch supervisor.

QUESTION ONE

"What is the part of your job nobody trained you for?"

Watch their face. Most have never been asked, and the answer comes out immediately and specifically, which tells you how long they have been carrying it.

QUESTION TWO

"What would help?"

This is the one that costs you something, because now you know. Then do one thing they say. Not a program. Not a committee. One thing, this month.

Want somebody to check on you?

This whole page argues that the failure is nobody following up. So we will follow up. Leave an address at the link below and we will send **one email, three weeks from now**, asking how it went. That is the entire list. One message, once, not a newsletter.

A straight answer about what is behind that link. The five moves, free and ungated, plus the full Teachers Deserve It library open through 30 November for anyone who works in a school. No card, and nothing turns into a charge. It is development built for the adults closest to the kids. It is not a trauma curriculum or an SEL program, and we would rather say so here than have you find out afterward.

What Do You Actually Want?

Five questions almost nobody gets asked. Answer them for yourself, then take this with you.

You cannot ask for training that helps if you have never named what would. This page is yours. Nobody collects it and nobody grades it.

1. The part of my job nobody trained me for is

Be specific. Not "behavior." The actual moment, on the actual day, that you were left to figure out alone.

2. The last training that genuinely changed something I do was

And what made that one different? Usually it is not the content. It is what happened after.

3. If I had one hour with somebody who really knows what they are doing, I would spend it on

One hour. Not a program. What would you actually use it for?

4. The thing I keep meaning to try, and never do, is

Everybody has one. Naming it is most of the work.

5. What would have to be true for me to still be doing it three weeks from now?

This is the real question. If the honest answer is "somebody would have to ask me about it," that is the whole point of this session.

Now take it with you. Your answer to question one is what you say when somebody asks what you need. Your answer to question five is what you ask them for. That is the two-sentence conversation on the previous page, already written.

The Twenty Most Used

Ranked by what people open and save in our library, not by what we would like to sell you.

PARA built for paraprofessionals and support staff • **TEACHER** built for classroom teachers

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|----|--|----|---|
| 01 | The First 10 Minutes Framework TEACHER | 11 | PA Quick Wins Menu PARA |
| 02 | Calm Response Scripts PARA TEACHER | 12 | Morning Meeting Framework TEACHER |
| 03 | The Noise Level System TEACHER | 13 | 10 Low-Lift Ways to Be Part of the Solution PARA TEACHER |
| 04 | Lesson Flow Checklist TEACHER | 14 | The Awesome Audit PARA TEACHER |
| 05 | 2x10 Strategy, PA Edition PARA | 15 | Burnout Early Warning System PARA TEACHER |
| 06 | Strategic Planning: A Teacher-First Tool TEACHER | 16 | Time-Saving Prompts for Teachers TEACHER |
| 07 | Para Quick-Start Confidence Kit PARA | 17 | The Language Playbook PARA TEACHER |
| 08 | Classroom Scenario Shuffle PARA TEACHER | 18 | PA Observation Guide PARA |
| 09 | The Shift Kit PARA TEACHER | 19 | No-Hands-Up Help Systems PARA TEACHER |
| 10 | Know Your Learners: Student Profile Builder TEACHER | 20 | De-Escalation Language Guide PARA TEACHER |

Ranked by views and saves in the Learning Hub, measured 6 September 2026. Every one is short enough to read and use in a single sitting. All twenty are open to anyone who works in a school through 30 November.

And the games, because practice beats reading

Short scenario games staff can run alone or in a staff meeting. All open to both roles.

Classroom Scenario Shuffle

10 min

What's Your Move?

10 min

Reset Roulette

8 min

Conversation Compass

12 min

Question Knockout

15 min

Partner Up

15 min

Twenty-six games in total. Classroom Scenario Shuffle is the most saved item in the whole library.

Do not see what you need?

This is the part we mean. If the thing your staff actually need is not on that list, tell us what it is and we will build it. That is not a customer service line, it is how most of this library got made in the first place.

Send it to hello@teachersdeserveit.com, or use the suggest a topic link on the page below. Tell us the role, the moment it happens in, and what you have already tried.

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